

HIGH HYDRATION SOURDOUGH



MAKES 1 loaf	ACTIVE TIME 30 min	REST 8-10 h bulk, then 1-6 h cold	OVEN 450F, 60 min total
ENERGY COST \$3.10 (60 min bake plus 30 min, 3.5 kW at 59 cents/kWh)		PRICE \$8	

DETAILS

- Tags: vegan

INGREDIENTS

50 g	Active starter
375 g	Warm water
500 g	Bread flour
9 g	Fine sea salt

METHOD

- Thursday to Friday, feed the starter.
- Saturday evening, make the dough. Sunday morning, bake.
- Mix the water with the starter. Form a rough dough and rest 1 hour.
- Work it into a ball, 15 to 20 seconds.
- Bulk rise 8 to 10 hours at room temperature.
- Dimple the dough all over with floured fingertips.
- Gently shape into a round and rest 5 to 10 minutes.
- Flip the dough and shape again, then flip it over. Shape once more and flip back.
- Into the bread basket, seam side up.
- Cover and refrigerate 1 hour, up to 6 if needed.
- Let it sit at room temperature while the oven heats. Preheat to 450F.
- Bake 20 minutes covered, 30 minutes with the lid off, then 10 minutes directly.

NOTES

The schedule is built around a weekend: feed Thursday and Friday, mix Saturday night, bake Sunday morning. Seam side up in the basket, so it goes seam down into the pot. The three-stage bake is 60 minutes total, longer than most recipes, and the final 10 minutes out of the pot is what sets the crust.

LEARNINGS

- 375 g of water against 500 g of flour is 75% hydration before the starter, which is where the name comes from. Counting the starter as half flour and half water, total hydration lands near 76%.
- The preheat line in the notebook has one temperature struck through with 450F written after it, so 450F is what is recorded here. Worth settling whether the struck-out figure was a hotter preheat that then drops for the bake.